CYBER SAFETY GUY

WATCH

A PARENT'S PLAIN-ENGLISH GUIDE

Apple Watch can help kids stay connected, safe and independent. But it's still a connected device with communication, location sharing and access to apps. Here's what parents need to know.

Varies
No UK minimum age, but managed by a parent

Stay Connected
Calls, texts, Walkie-Talkie & FaceTime (audio)

Location Sharing
See location in the Find My app (when enabled)

Apps, Music & Health Tracking
Access to apps, music and health features

Sources: Apple Support, Apple Watch User Guide, Internet Matters

WHAT PARENTS NEED TO UNDERSTAND

1. **It's a powerful communication tool**
Kids can make calls, send texts, use Walkie-Talkie and FaceTime (audio).

2. **You'll need a cellular model**
Apple Watch For Your Kids (Family Setup) only works on GPS + Cellular models (Series 6, SE or later, watchOS 7+).
GPS-only watches cannot use Family Setup.

3. **Location features add safety**
You can share location with your child and they can share theirs (if you allow it).

SAFETY FEATURES / SETTINGS

WHAT EXISTS	WHAT TO CHANGE
Family Setup Manage the watch for kids without an iPhone.	**Review Privacy Settings** Check what your child can share and with who.
Schooltime Limit distractions during school hours.	**Set Up Schooltime** Add schedules and allow only what's needed.
Screen Time Set time limits for apps and device use.	**Adjust Screen Time Limits** Set daily limits and downtime.
Location Sharing Share location with your child in the Find My app.	**Check App Access** Review and approve apps and purchases.
Content & Privacy Restrictions Block apps, content and explicit material.	**Enable Content Restrictions** Limit mature content and in-app purchases.

STEP-BY-STEP: SET UP SAFELY

1. Set up with Family Setup (from your iPhone).
2. Add your child's Apple ID (or create one together).
3. Configure location sharing in the Find My app.
4. Set Schooltime rules and schedules.
5. Turn on Content & Privacy Restrictions.
6. Talk together about safe use and boundaries.

THE RISKS WORTH KNOWING

- **Unexpected Contact** — Calls and messages can come from unknown numbers.
- **Location Misuse** — Location sharing can reveal routines or locations.
- **Inappropriate Content** — Apps, messages or web content may not be suitable.
- **Distractions** — Notifications and apps can affect focus and sleep.
- **In-App Purchases** — Apps and subscriptions can lead to unwanted costs.
- **Loss or Theft** — Personal data and payment cards could be a risk.



THE 10-MINUTE CONVERSATION



- What do you like most about your Apple Watch?
- Who do you talk to or message?
- What apps do you use the most?
- Who can you call or message on your watch?
- What would you do if someone made you feel uncomfortable?

TRUST OVER SURVEILLANCE

Open conversations build trust.
Kids are more likely to ask for help when they know they won't get into trouble.

IF THINGS GO WRONG

STAY CALM & GATHER EVIDENCE

- Take screenshots if needed.
- Note the time, date and what happened.
- Stop further contact if it feels unsafe.

REPORT & SEEK HELP

- Use Apple's reporting tools in Messages or FaceTime.
- Block unwanted contacts.
- Talk to a trusted adult.
- Contact police if there is immediate risk.



NEED TO TALK? CHILDLINE | **0800 1111** childline.org.uk | **YOU ARE NOT ALONE** We're here for you.

cybersafetyguy.com | 100% of subscription income donated to Childline (NSPCC)